Is the Biggest City Always the Capital?

Student sheet · Lycée général et technologique · Seconde générale et technologique · LVA B1+

Official page: https://itineraires-destinations.fr/is-the-biggest-city-always-the-capital/

Seven lessons of 55 minutes, timed for 52 minutes, plus a final-task assessment.

Name: _____ Class: _____

Key question: **Is the biggest city always the capital?**

Write on this sheet, or in your notebook. Answer keys are always visible on the official pages. Make your own bristol flashcards. If you have already studied The Capital Trap, do not copy those exercises again: use the short recap, then the new work (Washington, D.C., the Commonwealth, the debate, the final task).

Lesson 1. Water first, cities next

The engraving: where, when, which building represents political power?

Explain: “Transport shaped the map, but politics shaped the capitals.”

Two verbs in the passive in the text: _____ _____

Locate five places, with five different expressions:

Lesson 2. Comparing Cities

Inès’s mistake, in one sentence:

A French example of the trap, or of a capital that is also the biggest city:

Precise comparatives (2020 census figures are on the website):

Los Angeles is more than _____ times as big as Sacramento.

Houston is more than _____ as big as Austin.

Albany is nowhere near as _____ as New York City.

Three sentences comparing two French cities:

Lesson 3. A capital built for a deal

The deal of 1790: what did the North get? What did the South get?

Why is Washington, D.C. not a state capital?

The passive: The site _____ (choose) in 1791. The government _____ (move) to Washington in 1800. The city _____ (plan) on the Potomac.

Homework paragraph, first ideas (80 to 100 words, three passives, two connectors):

Lesson 4. Capitals by compromise

My expert country: _____ Five key words:

Country	Capital(s) / biggest city	When?	Who decided?	Why?
Canada				
Australia				
New Zealand				
South Africa				
India				
Nigeria				

Three points that several stories share:

Lesson 5. One Commonwealth, many capitals

True or false, then correct the false sentences:

All members used to be British colonies. _____

King Charles III is the head of state of every member. _____

The USA left the Commonwealth in 1776. _____

Permanence, break, or both? New Delhi: _____ Abuja: _____ Pretoria: _____ Canberra: _____ Wellington: _____

used to / whose: Lagos _____ the capital of Nigeria. Wellington is a city _____ harbour is excellent.

Lesson 6. Debate

The question: Should a capital be the biggest city? My role: _____

My three arguments, with an example each:

On the one hand… On the other hand… My opinion after the vote:

Lesson 7 and final task

My option: A (podcast) / B (article). US capital: _____ Commonwealth capital: _____

Part	My notes (key words only for the oral)
Introduction: the question	

Part	My notes (key words only for the oral)
Capital 1 (USA): when, who, why	
Capital 2 (Commonwealth): when, who, why	
Comparison	
My opinion and conclusion	

To get a good mark, I must: compare one US capital and one Commonwealth capital; give dates, the people who decided and the reasons; use complex comparatives, the passive and connectors; give and justify my opinion; for the oral, speak from five key words and pronounce the names correctly.

© 2026 Madame Carole Paoli Pompougnac · CC BY-NC-SA 4.0 · Official page: https://itineraires-destinations.fr/is-the-biggest-city-always-the-capital/